

Still Camera

This is the camera that launches by default, and will probably be the most used. In the settings screen you will see: Switch Camera, Shooting Mode Normal, Stabilisation, Burst and High Dynamic Range), Scene (Auto, Action, Whiteboard, Night and Beach or Snow), Flash (Auto, On and Off) and Aspect Ratio (1:1, 4:3 and 16:9).

Other Settings

You can drag the focus box around to tell the camera what to auto-focus on, wait for the object you're shooting to become clear, and then tap anywhere on the screen to click / start recording. You can also use the Volume Up/Down side keys on the device to click a photograph / record a video when in the Camera app.

When in the camera app, if you swipe down from the top bezel of the screen, you will see the Help and Settings icons. There are three basic settings here – Save on Media Card, Geotag Pictures, HDR Photo Capture. If you travel a lot we'd suggest you turn on Geotagging, but if you don't, save a teeny amount of battery and processor power by leaving it off. If you set the still camera to capture in HDR (High Dynamic Range) mode, turning on the HDR Photo Capture setting will save two pictures every time – one in HDR as you requested, and one in normal mode.

For those who don't know already, HDR is a method used to enhance photographs so that even dimly lit objects are seen as well as brightly lit ones. Let's face it, cameras are just not as sensitive and quick to change focus as our eyes are. Think about when you've watched a sporting event on TV that's being played in a stadium in the day time – most commonly football, cricket or tennis. When part of the stadium is sunny and part of it in shadow, at a football match for example, the TV cameras often take time to adjust to the different contrast levels needed. When the ball goes into a shadow covered area, and the TV camera follows it, you will often find that for a fraction of a second it's too dark, and then all of a sudden the camera adjusts and you can see clearly again. While this happens, you will also see any sunny part of the stadium (if visible in the distance) will become so bright that it's hard to make out details. If the same scene was HDR-ed on the fly, the entire football field would be clearly visible, and only a slight change in contrast would indicate that a portion of it was in a shadow.